of some fundamental shift taking place in the global economy. Hence, faced with cluster crises, it is important to occasionally step back and take a more holistic view of the situation. There has been some research trying to do precisely that.

(b) It does not seems too difficult to see what is happening, at one level – with rapid globalisation since the end of World War II, goods and services and also capital have begun moving much more freely across nations. The advance of IT has meant that it is possible for people with a modicum of skills to sit in one country and do work for another country – this adds a new dimension to the situation. Briefly saying, one of the most precious resources for economic progress, namely ***skilled labour,*** which earlier sat walled in within the boundaries of their respective nations, has suddenly become available to needs arising in distant parts of the world.

(c) As a result of all this, all emerging economies with a little ability to organise their workspace and impart skills to their workers are now capable of taking advantage of this windfall. The bottom end of the skilled-labour spectrum in the US and Europe now faces competition from the top end of the skilled labour band of India, China, the Philippines, Indonesia, and several other emerging economies. This has energised large corporations in rich and poor countries and caused booms in various regions, like *Silicon Valley* in the United States. But this is also causing inequality to rise in both industrialised nations and emerging economies.

(d) A recent paper[15] highlights how this process is one of the causes of growth and employment trends, within the US economy diverging and inequality rising. And ‘the major emerging economies are becoming more competitive in areas in which the U.S. economy has historically been dominant, such as the design and manufacture of semi-conductors, pharmaceuticals and information technology services’. By the same argument the skilled end of the labour markets in India and China is competing with its counterparts in industrialised nations and, as a consequence, its salaries are rising, resulting in growing inequality in these countries.